

Twilio Field Guide

Most Twilio failures are a setting, not a bug. A number still points at the demo TwiML URL, a campaign never finished registering, a webhook has no fallback. Every script here is read only.

4 fixes, each one a written note with diagrams and a small Python and Node.js script that finds the problem and repairs it. All 4 have a script in the public repo.

Before you run anything. Every script starts in a dry run: it reports what it would change and writes nothing. Read that output first, then set `DRY_RUN=false` when you are satisfied it has understood your data.

Scripts: github.com/allanninal/twilio-fixes

Guides: allanninal.dev/twilio

All 14 repos: github.com/allanninal

The fixes

1 inbound SMS disappears into a number with no sms_url

Outbound works perfectly. Replies do not arrive. There is no 4xx, no entry in the Debugger, no request in your access log — the inbound message is accepted by Twilio, matched to a number, and then delivered to nowhere. The STOP replies vanish the same way, which is the part that eventually costs money.

[twilio_inbound_route_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/twilio/inbound-webhook-black-hole/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/twilio-fixes/tree/main/inbound-webhook-black-hole>

2 a Messaging Service with no A2P campaign fails US sends

Staging was cloned from production last quarter and it has worked ever since — until the new tenant went live and every US message came back 30034. The brand is approved. The campaign is verified. Neither of them is attached to this Messaging Service, because A2P registration is per service and nobody registers the second one.

[twilio_a2p_registration_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/twilio/messaging-service-not-a2p-registered/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/twilio-fixes/tree/main/messaging-service-not-a2p-registered>

3 a number with no fallback URL drops the call when yours 500s

Your webhook was down for ninety seconds during a deploy. Twilio requested it, got a 502, logged an 11200 and hung up on whoever was calling. There was a mitigation for exactly this, it costs one field on the number, and it is empty on every number you own.

[twilio_fallback_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/twilio/phone-number-missing-fallback-url/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/twilio-fixes/tree/main/phone-number-missing-fallback-url>

4 a phone number still points at Twilio's demo TwiML

The number rings. It answers. It plays a cheerful message about Twilio and hangs up. Nothing appears in the Debugger, nothing appears in your logs, and every call in the console is marked completed — because the webhook Twilio fetched answered perfectly. It just was not yours.

[twilio_demo_twiml_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/twilio/phone-number-still-on-demo-twiml/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/twilio-fixes/tree/main/phone-number-still-on-demo-twiml>
